

Yacht Management & Marine Services

Freedom To enjoy

MARINE HQ

CREW STARTER KIT 1 OF 5

Get ready

The steps and costs before your first yacht job in Australia.

Name: _____ Role you want: _____ Home port: _____

Date: _____

1 BEFORE YOU SPEND A DOLLAR

- [ ] **Medical**
  Book a certificate of medical fitness before you pay for any course. A problem found afterwards is expensive.
- [ ] **STCW basic safety training**
  The baseline course, about eight days with theory and practical work. Ask the provider for the full price.
- [ ] **A role course, if you want one**
  Deckhand or stewardess course from an approved provider. Powerboat licence or hospitality skills.
- [ ] **Passport, bank account, tax file number**
  You will be paid into an Australian account and asked for all three.
- [ ] **Right to work in Australia**
  Citizen, permanent resident or the right visa. Ask a registered migration agent if you are not sure.
- [ ] **Your CV, ready to send**
  One page, a recent photo, certificates with expiry dates. Use the next page.
- [ ] **A phone that is on**
  Reply the same day. Captains fill gaps fast.

2 WHAT IT COSTS YOU fill in the quotes as you collect them

ITEM	PROVIDER	COST
Medical certificate		
STCW basic safety training		
Role course		
First-aid or other ticket		
Travel to the course		
Accommodation while training		
Work clothes and shoes		

NOTES quotes, dates, things to ask

CREW STARTER KIT 2 OF 5

Write your yacht CV

One page. What goes on it, and how to make it work.

1 WHAT GOES ON A YACHT CV

- [ ] **Name, phone, email, home port**
  Put them at the top. Add a photo: head and shoulders, plain background, smiling.
- [ ] **One line about you**
  Role you want, certificates held and when you are free. Two lines at most.
- [ ] **Certificates and expiry dates**
  List each one with its expiry. Put the most useful first.
- [ ] **Yachting experience**
  Boat, size, role, dates, what you did. If you have none, use daywork and any job that shows you work hard.
- [ ] **Other experience that counts**
  Hospitality, trades, cooking, childcare, drone, photography, first aid, languages, driving licence.
- [ ] **Two referees**
  Name, role, boat and phone number. Ask their permission first.

2 MAKE IT WORK

- [ ] **Keep it to one page**
  Captains read the top third. Make it count.
- [ ] **Use the boat's name only with permission**
  Say 'private motor yacht, 70 ft' if you are not sure.
- [ ] **Send a PDF, named properly**
  FirstName-LastName-Role.pdf. Not 'CV final 2'.
- [ ] **Check it twice**
  A typo in a CV tells a captain how you will clean a deck.

Your CV is your first interview. Write one for each role you want: a deckhand CV and a steward CV are different documents. Ask a friend to read it for typos.

CV DRAFT write your one-line pitch and your best three points

Name: _____ Date: _____

CREW STARTER KIT 3 OF 5

Messages that get a reply

Short, polite and specific. Fill in the brackets and send.

1 MESSAGE TO A CAPTAIN OR AGENT first contact

To a captain or agent, first contact: Hi [name], my name is [your name]. I am looking for [deckhand / stewardess / engineer / chef] work on yachts in Australia. I hold [certificates, with expiry]. I am [where you are] and free from [date]. My CV is attached. Could I have a few minutes, or put me down for daywork? Thanks, [your name], [phone].

2 DAYWORK MESSAGE at the dock or by phone

Daywork, at the dock: Good morning [name]. I am [your name], I hold [certificates]. If you need an extra pair of hands for the washing, polishing or a delivery, I am available this week. I can start at [time]. [phone].

3 FOLLOW-UP MESSAGE one week later

Follow-up, after a week with no reply: Hi [name], I wanted to follow up on my message of [date] about [role]. I am still available from [date]. Thank you for your time. [your name], [phone].

4 REFERENCE REQUEST to a past boss

Reference request: Hi [name], I am applying for yacht work and would be grateful if I could use you as a referee. I worked with you on [boat] from [date] to [date] as [role]. May I give your number to captains and agents? Thank you, [your name].

Short, polite and specific. Send it to one person at a time, by name. Do not send the same message to fifty captains.

MESSAGES SENT who, when, what they said

DATE TO REPLY

Name: _____ Date: _____

Interviews

What you will be asked, and what to ask back.

1 QUESTIONS YOU WILL BE ASKED

- [ ] **Why yachting?**
  Have an honest answer that is about the work, not the lifestyle.
- [ ] **Tell me about the hardest day you have had at work.**
  Pick a real one. Say what you did and what you learned.
- [ ] **What would you do if you saw something wrong and no one else had noticed?**
  Tell the captain, early and in writing.
- [ ] **How do you cope with long days and close quarters?**
  Give an example from a job or a trip.
- [ ] **Where are your certificates, and when do they expire?**
  Know the dates without looking.

2 QUESTIONS TO ASK

- [ ] **What does a typical week look like?**
- [ ] **Who would I report to?**
- [ ] **Is the role permanent, seasonal or relief?**
- [ ] **Which days are off, and how is leave handled?**
- [ ] **What do you pay, and when? Is superannuation on top?**
- [ ] **Do you provide food, uniform and travel to the boat?**
- [ ] **Is there a trial period, and how long?**

Interview rules. Turn up early, dressed for work. Bring your certificates. Look the captain in the eye. Say thank you. Then follow up within two days.

AFTER THE INTERVIEW

what went well, what you would change

Boat: _____ Date: _____

CREW STARTER KIT 5 OF 5

Keep track

Every application and every certificate in one place.

1 JOB-HUNT TRACKER one line per application

	BOAT OR AGENCY	CONTACT AND PHONE	ROLE	APPLIED	REPLY	NEXT STEP
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						

2 CERTIFICATE AND EXPIRY TRACKER check it every month

DOCUMENT	NUMBER	ISSUED	EXPIRES
Medical certificate			
STCW basic safety			
Role certificate			
First aid			
Licence or ticket			
Passport			

Looking for your first yacht? Marine HQ places crew on motor yachts across Australia. Send your CV, certificates and the dates you are free to yachtsupport@marinehq.com.au or call 0439 748 387.

NOTES anything to remember

Name: _____ Date: _____

MHQ-CS-001 · $19 · © Marine HQ Pty Ltd. An information document, not legal, employment or migration advice. Check award, visa and certificate rules with the relevant authority or an adviser. Not for resale.

Freedom To enjoy

m: 0439 748 387
e: yachtsupport@marinehq.com.au
w: www.marinehq.com.au

MARINE HQ